



10.9a | Time Management Challenges in Neurodivergent Minds



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Time management isn't just about discipline or scheduling apps. For neurodivergent people, it's often a daily battle with distorted perceptions and invisible barriers.

Time-Blindness

Time-blindness means lacking an internal clock that alerts you to the passage of time. You might fully intend to leave at 3:00 PM, but 3:00 feels no different than 1:00 or 5:00. The moment doesn't register until it's passed, leading to frequent lateness or last-minute rushes.

Difficulty Estimating Task Duration

Our brains often misjudge how long a task will take. This leads to overcommitment, delays, or skipping necessary prep steps. You might think, “I can knock this out in 15 minutes,” only to spend an hour stuck in unforeseen details. It's not carelessness—it's a processing mismatch.

Frequently Running Late

Being late isn't about not valuing someone's time. It's often a cascade: one minor delay dominoes into lost focus, forgotten items, or decision paralysis. Add time-blindness, and leaving "on time" becomes an unpredictable gamble.

Support Tips:

- Visual timers or countdown clocks
- Calendar alarms with context reminders
- Gentle nudges rather than blame